INKLINE

ALICIA RIDDLE PHOTOGRAPHY

Keyword Research & SEO Opportunity Report

aliciariddle.ca — February 2026

44
Total Keywords
across 5 categories

25
Quick Win Keywords
KD 0–15, 1–3 months

0
Current Rankings
brand-new site — all opportunity

7/8
Blue Ocean: Hockey
keywords at KD 0

1 Executive Summary

Alicia Riddle Photography is a brand-new studio offering family, corporate headshots, hockey, and pet photography services in the Ottawa-Gatineau market. The site is positioned to compete in a crowded family photography space, but possesses unique advantages in two underserved niches: hockey team photography and pet photography (leveraging Alicia's vet tech background).

This keyword research analyzed 44 high-potential search terms across five service categories using Semrush's competitive intelligence suite. We identified 25 "quick win" keywords achievable within 1–3 months through on-page optimization alone, and discovered a true blue ocean in hockey photography—an 8-keyword cluster with zero keyword difficulty.

Bottom Line

Hockey photography is a true blue ocean — virtually zero competition. Combined with achievable headshot and family keywords, Alicia can realistically rank for 19+ keywords within 3 months through on-page optimization alone.

2 Competitive Landscape

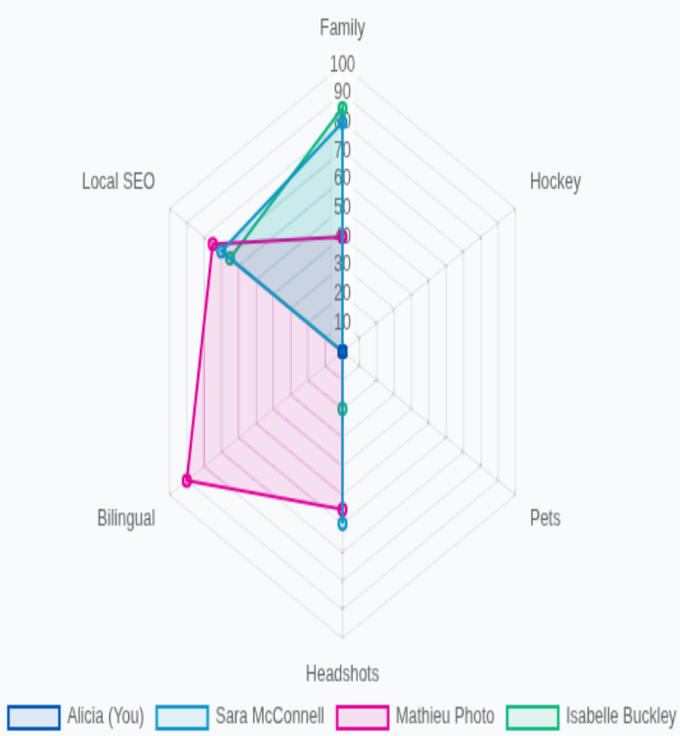
Direct Competitors (Client-Facing)

Competitor	Service Focus	Keywords	Top Ranking	Threat Level
saramcconnell.ca	Family, Maternity, Headshots	~50	family photography ottawa (#2)	High
mathieu-photo.com	Portraits, Weddings (EN/FR)	~50	photographe gatineau (#1)	High
isabellebuckleyphotography.ca	Family, Wedding	~50	family photographer ottawa (#2)	High
gillianmccollphotos.com	Newborn, Maternity, Family	~50	ottawa newborn photographer (#2)	Medium
lexinephotographie.com	Wedding, Hockey	~50	hockey team photos (#13)	Medium
clicplus.ca	Youth Sports Galleries	~23	Mostly branded traffic	Low

Semrush Competitive Set (Top Relevance)

Site	Relevance	Keywords	Monthly Traffic	Shared Competitors
melissagauthier.ca	62%	147	97	Gillian, Sara, Isabelle
kaylaphotography.ca	42%	134	503	Gillian, Sara, Mathieu
ofwilddawnphotography.com	43%	60	145	Isabelle, Mathieu
samparkphotography.com	39%	85	174	Mathieu, Gillian
joeyrudd.ca	17%	342	781	Mathieu
diamondviewphotography.com	52%	94	4	Gillian, Sara
jessicabarnett.ca	27%	89	118	Isabelle
gtasportsphotography.com	8%	98	416	Lexine (sports)

Competitive Positioning Radar



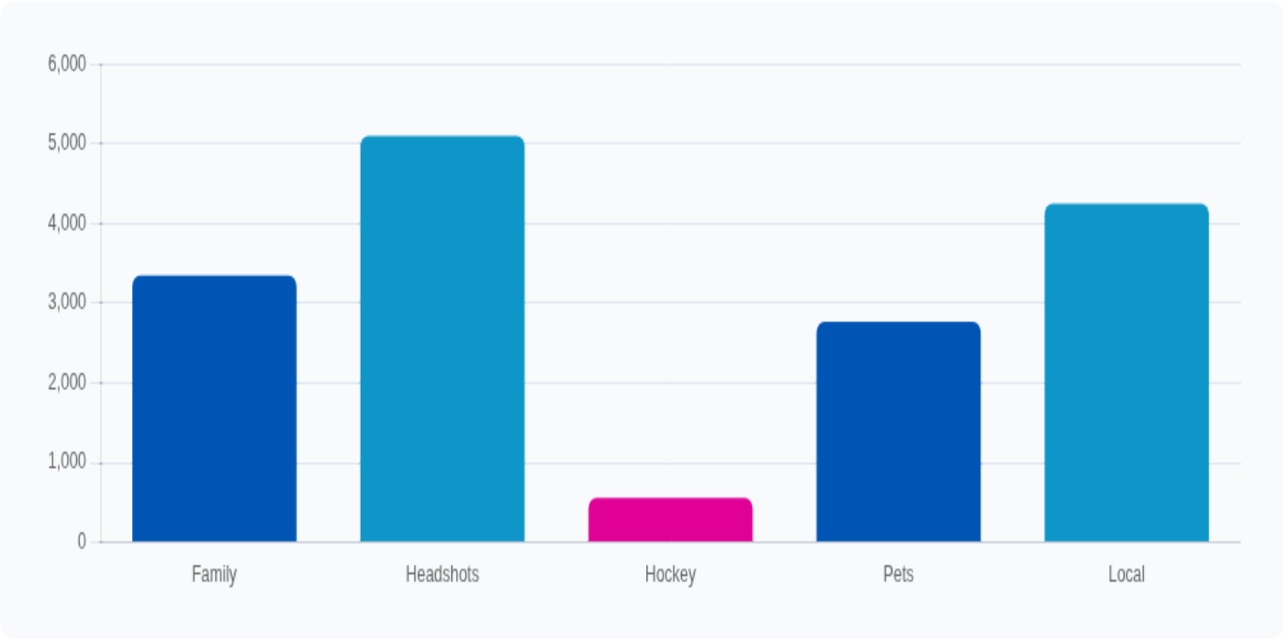
Radar shows relative competitive strength by service category (0–100 scale). Hockey, pets, and bilingual content are your competitive advantages.

Key Insight

The local competitive set averages 50+ ranked keywords and 100–500 monthly visits each. However, no competitor has a significant presence in hockey photography. Sara and Isabelle dominate family photography; Mathieu dominates bilingual SEO. Your differentiation lies in hockey + pet photography + bilingual expansion.

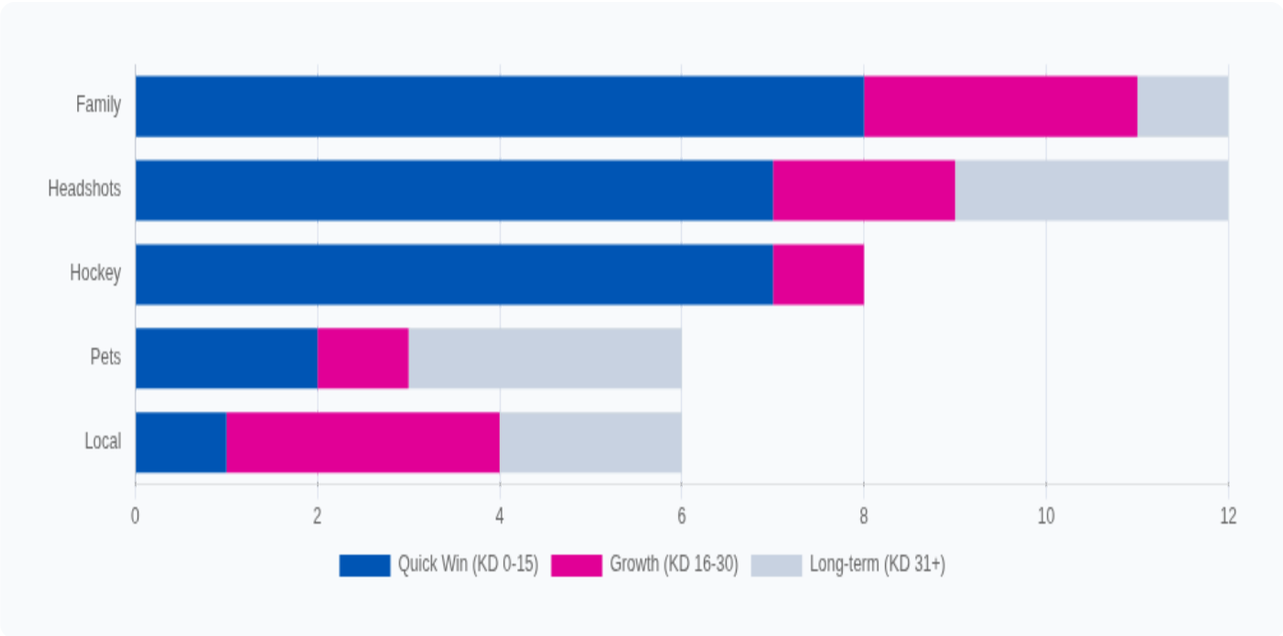
3 Keyword Opportunities

Search Volume by Category



Headshots and Local categories have the highest combined search volume. Hockey is niche but uncontested.

Priority Distribution by Category



Hockey has the highest ratio of quick-win keywords (7 of 8). Family and Headshots are balanced across all priority levels.

Family Photography Keywords

Family photography is the largest market opportunity (3,350 total monthly volume). Eight keywords are achievable quick wins with KD ≤15. Focus on

local modifiers ('near me', 'ottawa') and seasonal angles ('family photo outfit ideas'). Family portraits is competitive but has solid volume.

Keyword	Volume	KD	CPC	Priority
family photography near me	170	4	$0.66	Quick Win
family photographer near me	170	8	$0.72	Quick Win
family photos ottawa	90	8	$0.52	Quick Win
family photographer ottawa	110	11	$0.47	Quick Win
family photoshoot near me	260	12	$0.54	Quick Win
ottawa family photographer	110	13	$0.47	Quick Win
family photo session	140	0	$0.54	Quick Win
family photo studio near me	140	0	$0.51	Quick Win
family pictures ottawa	90	20	$0.52	Growth
family photography ottawa	70	25	$0.57	Growth
family portrait studio	390	26	$0.64	Growth
family photos	1600	33	$0.58	Long-term

Corporate Headshot Keywords

Headshots have the highest CPC ($1.07–$2.72) and strong volume. Three quick-win keywords (team headshots, corporate portraits, executive headshots) are all KD 0. LinkedIn headshots and business headshots are competitive but valuable for professional targeting.

Keyword	Volume	KD	CPC	Priority
ottawa headshot photographer	50	6	$1.07	Quick Win
headshots ottawa	170	8	$1.34	Quick Win
headshot photography near me	110	14	$1.24	Quick Win
professional headshot near me	90	16	$1.30	Quick Win
team headshots	20	0	$2.51	Quick Win
corporate portraits	30	0	$0.00	Quick Win
executive headshots	30	0	$2.72	Quick Win
professional headshots	1900	22	$1.52	Growth
headshot photographer	170	23	$1.21	Growth
linkedin headshots	260	39	$1.07	Long-term
corporate photography	140	47	$1.45	Long-term
business headshots	260	50	$2.58	Long-term

Hockey Photography Keywords (BLUE OCEAN)

This is the standout category: 7 of 8 keywords have KD 0. Hockey team photos (140 vol/mo), hockey photography (110 vol/mo), and hockey photographer are immediate ranking opportunities. The local hockey community is underserved—this is your fastest path to visibility.

Keyword	Volume	KD	CPC	Priority
hockey team photos	140	0	$0.00	Quick Win
hockey photography	110	7	$1.00	Quick Win
hockey photographer	20	0	$0.61	Quick Win
youth hockey photography	20	0	$0.00	Quick Win
hockey portrait	20	0	$0.00	Quick Win
hockey media day	20	0	$0.00	Quick Win
photographe hockey	20	0	$0.00	Quick Win
hockey player photoshoot	210	25	$0.00	Growth

Pet Photography Keywords

Pet portraits (1,300/mo, KD 56) is competitive but valuable long-term. Dog photoshoot (720/mo, KD 24) and pet photoshoot (90/mo, KD 16) are faster wins. This category benefits from Alicia's unique vet tech background—emphasize animal welfare and stress-free experiences.

Keyword	Volume	KD	CPC	Priority
pet photoshoot	90	16	$1.23	Quick Win
dog photoshoot	720	24	$1.42	Quick Win
dog photography	260	30	$0.64	Growth
pet photography near me	140	38	$0.00	Long-term
pet photography	260	40	$0.86	Long-term
pet portraits	1300	56	$1.13	Long-term

Local & Bilingual Keywords

Photographe gatineau (210/mo, KD 24) is a solid quick win on the French side. Photographer near me (2,400/mo) and photographers near me (1,000/mo) have high volume but moderate KD. Local SEO optimization (Google Business Profile, local schema, citations) is critical here.

Keyword	Volume	KD	CPC	Priority
photographe gatineau	210	24	$0.69	Quick Win
photographers near me	1000	18	$0.98	Growth
portrait photographer	170	26	$0.93	Growth
photographer near me	2400	28	$0.97	Growth
photography ottawa	210	36	$1.18	Long-term
ottawa photographer	260	40	$1.29	Long-term

4 3-Phase Implementation Strategy

Phase 1: Quick Wins (Weeks 1–6, March 2026)

Target: 10–12 rankings (KD 0–15 keywords across Hockey, Family, and Headshots)

- Launch 5 new pages: /hockey, /hockey/media-days, /family, /corporate, /pets
- On-page optimization: target keywords in title, H1, meta description, image alt text, 2–3 internal links per page
- Publish 4 blog posts (hockey, family, headshots, pets): 1,000–1,500 words, keyword-rich, service-linked
- Build local SEO: Complete Google Business Profile, add location schema, local citations (Yelp, BNI, chamber)
- Win 5–8 hockey keywords (all KD 0), 3–4 family quick wins, 2–3 headshot quick wins

Phase 2: Growth & Authority (Weeks 7–14, April–June 2026)

Target: 8–10 additional rankings (KD 16–30 keywords); build authority and bilingual presence

- Publish 12 blog posts over 8 weeks (1–2 per week) targeting mid-difficulty keywords and seasonal themes
- French-language optimization: Publish 3–4 French blog posts (photographe gatineau, séance photo), build FR landing pages
- Link building: 10–15 local directory placements (photography directories, Ottawa business sites), 1–2 press mentions
- Content cross-linking: Build topic clusters (family + seasons, pets + unique angle, headshots + industry verticals)
- Video strategy: 3–4 short portfolio or process videos (YouTube/Instagram), optimized for SEO
- Win 3–4 dog/pet keywords, 2–3 family growth keywords, 2–3 headshot growth keywords, 1–2 bilingual keywords

Phase 3: Authority & Expansion (Weeks 15+, July 2026+)

Target: Establish topical authority; rank for high-volume, high-competition keywords (KD 30+)

- Publish 2–3 authoritative pillar content pieces (1,500–2,500 words) per quarter: "Complete Guide to [Topic]"
- Build backlinks via guest posting, partnerships with local influencers, press coverage, industry awards
- Create multimedia content: webinars, interactive tools (outfit chooser for families, pose guide for headshots)
- Expand French SEO: Full bilingual site architecture, FR blog publishing 2x/month
- Long-tail targeting: Create content for hyper-local and specific niche searches (e.g., 'hockey media day in orleans', 'dog portraits for senior dogs')
- Target: 5–10 long-tail and competitive keywords (KD 30–50)

5 6-Month Content Calendar (March–August 2026)

March 2026

Phase 1: Hockey & Family Quick Wins

What to Expect at a Hockey Team Photo Day

Keywords: hockey team photos, hockey media day (KD 0)
Target Page: /hockey

The Ultimate Guide to Hockey Photography: Capturing the Game

Keywords: hockey photography, hockey photographer (KD 0–7)
Target Page: /hockey

Family Photo Outfit Ideas: What to Wear for Your Ottawa Session

Keywords: family photo outfit ideas (720/mo), family photoshoot clothes ideas (720/mo)
Target Page: /family

Why Aylmer Is the Perfect Backdrop for Family Portraits

Keywords: family photos ottawa, family photographer ottawa (KD 8–11)
Target Page: /family

April 2026

Phase 1: Headshots & Hockey

How to Prepare for Professional Headshots: A Complete Guide

Keywords: headshots ottawa, headshot photography near me (KD 8–14)
Target Page: /corporate

Youth Hockey Photography: Tips for Parents and Coaches

Keywords: youth hockey photography, hockey portrait (KD 0)
Target Page: /hockey

Team Headshots: Why Every Business Needs Updated Group Photos

Keywords: team headshots, corporate portraits (KD 0)
Target Page: /corporate

Behind the Lens: A Day at Robinson Arena Hockey Media Day

Keywords: hockey media day, hockey team photos (KD 0)
Target Page: /hockey

May 2026

Phase 1/2 Transition: Pets & Family

Why Your Pet Deserves a Professional Photoshoot

Keywords: pet photoshoot, dog photoshoot (KD 16–24)
Target Page: /pets

Spring Family Photo Sessions in Ottawa-Gatineau: Booking Guide

Keywords: family photoshoot near me, family photo session (KD 0–12)
Target Page: /family

Executive Headshots: Making the Right First Impression

Keywords: executive headshots, professional headshot near me (KD 0–16)
Target Page: /corporate

From Vet Tech to Pet Photographer: My Journey with Animals

Keywords: pet photography, dog photography (KD 24–30)
Target Page: /pets

June 2026

Phase 2: Growth Keywords

Photographe à Gatineau : Guide complet pour vos portraits de famille

Keywords: photographe gatineau (210/mo, KD 24)
Target Page: /fr-ca pages

The Best Dog Photoshoot Ideas for Every Breed

Keywords: dog photoshoot (720/mo, KD 24), animal photoshoot
Target Page: /pets

How to Choose the Right Photographer Near You

Keywords: photographer near me (2,400/mo), photographers near me (1,000/mo)
Target Page: Sitewide

Hockey Player Portraits: From Ice to Studio

Keywords: hockey player photoshoot (210/mo, KD 25)
Target Page: /hockey

July 2026

Phase 2: Bilingual & Cross-Service

Séance photo professionnelle : comment bien se préparer

Keywords: photo professionnelle (880/mo), photographe professionnel
Target Page: /fr-ca pages

Including Your Pets in Family Photos: Tips from a Vet-Turned-Photographer

Keywords: family photography with dogs (70/mo), family portrait with dog
Target Page: /family + /pets

Summer Mini Sessions in Ottawa: What You Need to Know

Keywords: family photography ottawa, family pictures ottawa (KD 20–25)
Target Page: /family

LinkedIn Headshots That Get You Noticed: A Photographer's Guide

Keywords: linkedin headshots (260/mo, KD 39), professional headshots (1,900/mo)
Target Page: /corporate

August 2026

Phase 2/3: Authority Building

The Complete Guide to Pet Portraits: From Playful to Regal

Keywords: pet portraits (1,300/mo, KD 56), pet photography (KD 40)
Target Page: /pets

Back-to-School Family Photos: Capture the Moment

Keywords: family photos (1,600/mo, KD 33), fall family photos (880/mo)
Target Page: /family

Photography in Ottawa: Your Guide to the City's Best Photographers

Keywords: photography ottawa (KD 36), ottawa photographer (KD 40)
Target Page: Sitewide

Why Every Business Needs Professional Corporate Photography

Keywords: corporate photography (KD 47), business headshots (KD 50)
Target Page: /corporate

Content Strategy Notes

- Each blog post should be 1,000–1,500 words and link to at least 2–3 relevant service pages internally
- Publish 4 posts per month (1 per week) during Phases 1–2, scaling to 8 posts per month in Phase 3
- Seasonal angles (e.g., spring family photos, back-to-school) capture demand spikes and improve click-through rates
- Cross-service posts (e.g., "Family + Pets", "Hockey + Headshots") deepen topic clusters and internal linking
- French content targets bilingual Ottawa-Gatineau audience; Mathieu-photo.com is your primary FR SEO competitor
- Use Alicia's vet tech background as a unique angle for pet photography—emphasize stress-free, animal-first approach

6 Recommended Next Steps (Immediate Actions)

1 Set Up Google Business Profile & Local SEO (Week 1)

- Claim and optimize GBP for aliciariddle.ca with full details, high-quality photos, service categories
- Add local schema (LocalBusiness, Service) to homepage
- Create local citations on Yelp, BNI, Ottawa Chamber of Commerce, Google Maps

2 Create High-Priority Service Pages (Weeks 1–2)

- /hockey: 800+ words, target 'hockey photography', 'hockey photographer', 'hockey team photos'
- /family: 800+ words, target 'family photography near me', 'family photos ottawa'
- /corporate or /headshots: 800+ words, target 'headshots ottawa', 'professional headshots'
- Include unique USP (vet tech background for pets, local community focus for hockey)

3 Launch Blog & Publish First 4 Posts (Weeks 2–3)

- Set up blog section with category structure (Hockey, Family, Corporate, Pets, Local)
- Publish 4 posts: 1 per category, targeting quick-win keywords (see Phase 1 content calendar)
- Each post: 1,000–1,500 words, keyword-rich, 2–3 internal links to service pages

4 Set Up SEO Tools & Analytics (Week 1)

- Link Semrush or Ahrefs account to site; set up daily ranking tracking for all 44 keywords
- Install Google Analytics 4 and Google Search Console; link to Google Business Profile
- Set up monthly reporting to track progress against Phase targets (see benchmarks above)

5 Plan French-Language Expansion (Weeks 3–4)

- Audit current bilingual capabilities; plan site structure (separate /fr-ca/ paths or hreflang)
- Draft 2–3 French blog posts for publication in April (photographe gatineau, séance photo, etc.)
- Hire French copywriter or translator if needed; ensure native-level French writing

6 Build Initial Backlink Strategy (Weeks 2–4)

- Reach out to 10–15 local directories and photography websites for links
- Claim existing mentions (Inkline portfolio, school photography directories, etc.)
- Plan 2–3 guest posts for local blogs or photography industry sites (target for April–May publication)

Success Metrics (3-Month Check-in, May 2026)

- **Rankings:** 10–15 keywords in top 20 (5+ in top 10)
- **Traffic:** 300–500 monthly visits from organic search
- **Pages:** 5–8 optimized service pages + 8–10 blog posts live
- **Engagement:** Average time-on-page ≥1:30, bounce rate ≤65%
- **Conversions:** 5–10 inquiry-form submissions (depends on traffic)